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Approved By	Jacob Honick, Owner
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QP-023 Customer Communication

Standards and clause references are guidance only and do not claim certification or standard compliance. Applicable customer, contractual and legal requirements govern accepted work.

1. Purpose

Define the process for managing customer communications, handling customer complaints, and performing post-delivery support activities including warranty, returns, and field investigation.

2. Scope

Applies to all customer communications related to quality, delivery, product conformity, complaints, and post-delivery activities for all contracts and orders.

3. Responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
Shop Owner	Respond to customer inquiries, receive and document complaints, initiate corrective actions, provide notification of quality escapes or delivery issues, manage post-delivery activities (warranty returns, field investigations)

4. References

- QF-022 — Customer Complaint Form
- QP-008 — Nonconforming Product Control
- QP-009 — Corrective Action
- QP-017 — Product Safety
- AS9100 Rev D Clause 8.2.1 (Customer Communication)
- AS9100 Rev D Clause 8.5.5 (Post-Delivery Activities)

5. Definitions

- **Customer Complaint:** Any expression of dissatisfaction from the customer regarding product quality, delivery, documentation, or service.
- **Notification Trigger:** An event requiring proactive communication to the customer before they discover the issue.
- **Post-Delivery Activity:** Any support, warranty, return, or investigation activity occurring after product has been delivered to the customer.

6. Procedure

Communication Methods and Documentation

1. Customer communications regarding quality or contractual matters shall be documented. Acceptable methods: email (retained), phone (followed up with email summary), or formal letter.
2. Retain records of quality-related communications in the job file or customer folder for the duration of the record retention period.

Complaint Handling

1. Upon receipt of a customer complaint:
    - Acknowledge receipt to the customer within 24 hours.
    - Initiate QF-022 Customer Complaint Record: date received, customer, description of complaint, affected part/PO/job numbers.
2. Investigate the complaint: determine root cause, scope (how many parts affected), and whether corrective action is required.
3. Provide the customer with a formal response including: findings, corrective/preventive actions taken, and timeline for resolution.
4. If corrective action is warranted, initiate per QP-009.
5. Close QF-022 when the customer accepts the response and corrective actions are verified effective.

Notification Triggers (Proactive)

1. Notify the customer proactively when ANY of the following occur:
    - Nonconforming product has been shipped (quality escape) — notify within 24 hours of discovery.
    - Safety-critical nonconformance discovered (per QP-017) — notify within 24 hours.
    - Delivery will not meet the committed date — notify as soon as the delay is known.
    - Process or source change that may require customer approval.
2. Record all proactive notifications: date, method, person contacted, information provided, customer response.

Record Retention

1. Retain customer complaint records (QF-022) and associated corrective actions under QP-001 and SUP-003 for at least ten years after the relevant last shipment or record completion, applying the longest customer, contract, program or legal requirement.

5. Post-Delivery Activities

Warranty and Returns

1. When a customer reports a quality issue after delivery (warranty claim or return):
    - Issue a Return Material Authorization (RMA) number.
    - Upon receipt of returned product, inspect and document findings on QF-022.
    - Disposition per QP-008 (rework, replace, or credit as appropriate).
2. Retain records of returned product disposition for the contract retention period.

Field Investigation Support

1. When a customer requests investigation support for product in service:
    - Provide technical data, manufacturing records, and inspection records as requested.
    - Support failure analysis by providing process history, material certifications, and dimensional records.
2. Document all field investigation support provided, including data released to the customer.

Record Retention After Delivery

1. Retain manufacturing records (inspection data, material certs, process records, FAI) for the greater of:
   - 10 years after the relevant last delivery, OR
   - The period specified by customer contract/purchase order, OR
   - As required by applicable regulations
2. Records subject to retention include: inspection reports, material certifications, NCRs/CARs, FAI packages, and traceability data.

7. Records Generated

Form No.	Title	When Completed
QF-022	Customer Complaint Record	Upon receipt of any customer complaint or warranty return

8. Revision History

Rev	Date	Description	Approved By
A	2026-08-07	Initial release	Shop Owner

Revision B Approval

Approved 2026-11-05 by Jacob Honick, Owner. Standardize control metadata and annual review, remove fixed page counts and align applicable references and wording.